

Middle East Daily Brief

June 24, 2026

Executive summary

8 stories from 6 outlets (5 perspectives) over the reporting window. Leading the day: UN commission of inquiry says Israel committing genocide in Gaza by deliberately targeting children.

Top stories

1. **UN commission of inquiry says Israel committing genocide in Gaza by deliberately targeting children** *Al Jazeera, BBC, Democracy Now, Express Tribune, Haaretz, Middle East Eye, UN News, US News · corroborated by 8 outlets* A three-member UN independent commission of inquiry said in a report released Tuesday that Israeli authorities and forces have deliberately targeted Palestinian children, amounting to genocide and atrocity crimes in Gaza and war crimes in... <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/6/23/israels-deliberate-targeting-of-gaza-children-part-of-genocide-un-inquiry>
2. **Israeli troops kill two in south Lebanon after lull in fighting, authorities say** *BBC, Al Jazeera, Middle East Eye, Times of Israel · corroborated by 4 outlets* Lebanese authorities said Israeli troops killed two men in southern Lebanon after several days of relative calm. Israel's military said the two were Hezbollah operatives, while the Iran-backed group accused Israel of violating the... <https://www.bbc.co.uk/news/articles/c36ykp0yego>
3. **Dozens of ships transit Strait of Hormuz as more vessels venture through, but the waterway's future stays unsettled** *Arab News, Al Arabiya, Al Jazeera, BBC · corroborated by 4 outlets* Maritime tracking data showed dozens of ships passing through the Strait of Hormuz in the days after the US-Iran deal — including 42 vessels on Saturday — though traffic remained well below pre-war levels. Pakistan's Deputy PM and Foreign... <https://www.arabnews.com/node/2648204/middle-east>
4. **Iran says no new commitments on nuclear sites after Vance says inspectors to be invited back** *BBC, Al Jazeera, Arab News, Times of Israel · corroborated by 4 outlets* Iran's foreign ministry said it made 'no new commitments' on nuclear inspections following talks in Switzerland, directly contradicting VP JD Vance's claim that Tehran had agreed to readmit IAEA inspectors to damaged nuclear sites.... <https://www.bbc.co.uk/news/articles/c3vy3nr63gxo>
5. **Iran's chief negotiator Ghalibaf says Strait of Hormuz will be administered by Tehran** *Al Arabiya, Arab News · corroborated by 2 outlets* Iran's chief negotiator Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf said the Strait of Hormuz 'will never return to its pre-war conditions and will be administered by the Islamic Republic of Iran, in accordance with international law,' according to state... <https://english.alarabiya.net/News/middle-east/2026/06/23/iran-chief-negotiator-ghalibaf-says-hormuz-will-be-administered-by-tehran-state-media>
6. **Israel-Lebanon direct talks wrap up in Washington after eight hours, to resume at Pentagon** *Times of Israel, Jerusalem Post · corroborated by 2 outlets* Direct talks between Israel and Lebanon concluded in Washington after more than eight hours covering both political and security issues, with sessions set to resume Wednesday at the Pentagon for security-focused discussions before... <https://www.timesofisrael.com/liveblog-june-23-2026/>

By theme

Israel – Gaza & the Palestinians

- **UN commission of inquiry says Israel committing genocide in Gaza by deliberately targeting children** — Al Jazeera, BBC, Democracy Now, Express Tribune, Haaretz, Middle East Eye, UN News, US News <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/6/23/israels-deliberate-targeting-of-gaza-children-part-of-genocide-un-inquiry>

Iran & the US

- **Dozens of ships transit Strait of Hormuz as more vessels venture through, but the waterway's future stays unsettled** — Arab News, Al Arabiya, Al Jazeera, BBC <https://www.arabnews.com/node/2648204/east>
- **Iran says no new commitments on nuclear sites after Vance says inspectors to be invited back** — BBC, Al Jazeera, Arab News, Times of Israel <https://www.bbc.co.uk/news/articles/c3vy3nr63gxo>
- **Iran's chief negotiator Ghalibaf says Strait of Hormuz will be administered by Tehran** — Al Arabiya, Arab News <https://english.alarabiya.net/News/middle-east/2026/06/23/iran-chief-negotiator-ghalibaf-says-hormuz-will-be-administered-by-tehran-state-media>
- **Trump says anyone in Congress critical of Iran deal 'has to be educated'** — Times of Israel, BBC <https://www.timesofisrael.com/liveblog-june-23-2026/>

Lebanon & Hezbollah

- **Israel-Lebanon direct talks wrap up in Washington after eight hours, to resume at Pentagon** — Times of Israel, Jerusalem Post <https://www.timesofisrael.com/liveblog-june-23-2026/>

Israel – politics & society

- **Israeli troops kill two in south Lebanon after lull in fighting, authorities say** — BBC, Al Jazeera, Middle East Eye, Times of Israel <https://www.bbc.co.uk/news/articles/c36ykpW0yego>
- **Israeli government funds plan to turn Palestinian archaeological site into settler facility** — Middle East Monitor <https://www.middleeastmonitor.com/20260623-israeli-government-funds-plan-to-turn-palestinian-archaeological-site-into-settler-facility>

Perspective balance

Perspective	Stories
international	2
Saudi	2
Israeli	2
Qatari	1
pro-Palestinian	1

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